

A Three-Interface Data-based Wireless Communication Timeout Fault Diagnosis Method for China Train Control System

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Abstract—The high-speed train control system is a crucial core equipment ensuring punctual departure and efficient operation of high-speed trains, while wireless timeout faults have always been a challenging issue in its operation and maintenance. Currently, fault diagnosis and maintenance heavily rely on manual planned inspections and post-event handling, leading to low diagnostic efficiency. To address this problem, this paper proposes an intelligent diagnosis method based on three-interface data, utilizing the random forest classification model to improve diagnostic efficiency and reduce the probability of fault occurrences. The paper introduces the communication principles and typical case analysis between the train vehicle speed protection equipment and the ground radio block center in the high-speed train control system. It then elaborates on the fault diagnosis method based on three-interface data, aiming to provide an effective means for dynamic health management of high-speed train control system equipment, ensuring safe and efficient operation of high-speed trains. Through the research presented in this paper, strong support can be provided for handling wireless timeout faults in high-speed train control systems, contributing to the improvement of train operation quality and efficiency.

Keywords—train control system; fault diagnosis; Three-interface data; random forest

I. INTRODUCTION

The high-speed train control system is one of the crucial core components for ensuring the on-time departure and efficient operation of high-speed trains. According to the design specifications of China's high-speed railways, the high-speed railways with a design speed of 250 kilometers per hour or above adopt the CTCS-3 train control system. In the CTCS-3 train control system, the wireless communication between the vehicle Automatic Train Protection (ATP) equipment and the Ground Radio Block Center (RBC) is achieved through the GSM-R network, enabling bidirectional transmission of messages[1]. This facilitates the Train Control Center to issue mobile authorization commands to high-speed trains and ensures the enforcement of safe operating intervals. Since the first operation of the Wuhan-Guangzhou high-speed railway, which utilized the CTCS-3 train control system in 2009, the wireless communication timeout issue between the train's vehicle CTCS-3 equipment and the ground control system has consistently posed a significant challenge in the maintenance and

improvement of railway signal reliability. As existing and newly constructed railway lines are operating at speeds of up to 350 kilometers per hour, this communication timeout issue has gradually become a critical factor restricting further speed increases and affecting train operation efficiency. On the other hand, in current practical production, the diagnosis and maintenance of the train-ground wireless communication timeout faults still heavily rely on manual planned inspections and post-event repairs. This traditional approach results in low diagnostic efficiency and lacks efficient intelligent diagnostic methods.

Based on the background mentioned above, this article proposes an intelligent diagnostic method for train-ground wireless communication timeout faults based on three-interface data. The core of this method involves utilizing a Random Forest classification model to achieve fault diagnosis. Firstly, the data from the three interfaces (A, Abis, and PRI) of the high-speed train control system is subjected to preprocessing and divided into training and testing sets[2]. Next, the training set data is used to train the Random Forest classifier, resulting in a diagnostic model for train-ground wireless communication faults. Subsequently, the diagnostic model is utilized to detect and classify faults in the testing set data. Finally, an evaluation and analysis of metrics, including accuracy, are conducted on the diagnostic model. The results indicate that the proposed method efficiently diagnoses train-ground wireless communication timeout faults with a high level of accuracy [3].

II. VEHICLE-GROUND WIRELESS COMMUNICATION PRINCIPLE OF THE HIGH-SPEED TRAIN CONTROL SYSTEM

The CTCS-3 train control system utilizes wireless communication (GSM-R) to establish continuous, bidirectional, and high-capacity message transmission between trains and the ground control center. It also employs track circuits to check the occupancy status of train block sections and utilizes ground transponder to calibrate positioning information. In the CTCS-3 train control system, the rail vehicle equipment(Fig.1) is responsible for receiving ground data and command information, generating speed mode curves, monitoring train operation, and ensuring the safety of train operations. The ground signaling equipment(Fig.2) generates and sends movement authorities to trains based on information received

from interlocking devices, adjacent RBC, temporary speed restriction servers, and interactions with vehicle train equipment. This allows trains to safely operate within the jurisdiction of the RBC, ensuring train interval control and train protection on the designated railway tracks. The CTCS-3 train-ground wireless communication transmission system consists of vehicle wireless transmission equipment, the Ground Radio Block Center (RBC), and the GSM-R network, enabling wireless communication between trains and the ground. If any side experiences abnormalities, it may result in train-ground wireless communication timeout faults. The schematic diagram of the train-ground wireless communication transmission system is shown in Fig.3.



Fig. 1: Rail vehicle equipment.



Fig. 2: The ground signaling equipment.

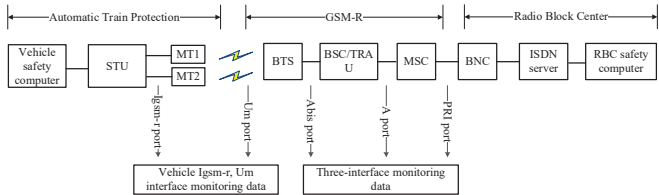


Fig. 3: Structure of the train-ground wireless transmission system.

In the transmission process, the communication data between the CTCS-3 train control system and the ground passes through numerous network elements. The interfaces

involved primarily include Isgm-r, Um, Abis, A, and PRI. The monitoring data from the Isgm-r and Um interfaces can only be collected by trains equipped with air interface devices and is not universally applicable. Therefore, this study primarily relies on existing PRI, A, and Abis interface monitoring data, including the Abis-interface data between the BTS (Base Transceiver Station) and BSC (Base Station Controller). The main focus of monitoring is on handover between cells, signal interactions, uplink and downlink reception levels, and quality of vehicle terminal modules, reflecting the quality of communication network utilization. Additionally, A-interface signaling messages and handover events between MSC and BSC/TRAU are also included in the study. The PRI-interface data exchanged between the MSC (Mobile Switching Center) and RBC (Radio Block Center) includes both wireless communication aspects (physical layer, data link layer, network layer, and transport layer) and signaling-related content (security layer, application layer).

III. TYPICAL CASE ANALYSIS

In practical applications, various factors such as unstable ATP equipment operation, RBC or ATP software defects, communication G-network device obstacles, external radio frequency interference, and other reasons can lead to train-ground wireless communication timeout faults. In some cases, these issues can even result in train downgrading, significantly impacting the efficiency of train operations[4].

A. The Vehicle Equipment's MT Radio Fault

The characteristic manifestation of such a fault is that wireless connection timeouts occur at each RBC handover zone. Let's further analyze the data to gain more insights.

On November 13, 2022, during the operation of the CRH380D-1546 high-speed train on the G7615 service from Nanjing South Station, multiple wireless timeout brake failure alarms occurred. Analysis of the data from the three interfaces (PRI port call records or A port call records) revealed that only one vehicle MT (Mobile Terminal) was operational, as shown in Fig. 4 and 5.

序号	触发时间	MT名称/ID	机车号	车次号	线路	消息类型	RSCAP类型	SCCP类型
13	2022-11-13 17:35:18.7010	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
14	2022-11-13 17:36:12.8450	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
15	2022-11-13 17:37:55.4760	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
16	2022-11-13 17:43:19.1460	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
17	2022-11-13 17:44:42.5740	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
18	2022-11-13 17:45:19.7640	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
19	2022-11-13 17:45:58.9480	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
20	2022-11-13 17:46:49.0930	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
21	2022-11-13 17:47:35.3660	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
22	2022-11-13 17:48:09.3110	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
23	2022-11-13 17:48:24.2810	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
24	2022-11-13 17:49:21.1060	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
25	2022-11-13 17:49:52.4530	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
26	2022-11-13 17:50:38.8010	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
27	2022-11-13 17:51:09.2770	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
28	2022-11-13 17:51:36.3400	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
29	2022-11-13 17:52:29.9380	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1
30	2022-11-13 17:53:12.7990	44904184065	15461	67615	宁杭	SSCMAP	HANDOVER_PREFERRED	DT1

Fig. 4: A interface call records for service G7615.

序号	触发时间	ISDN/URI	SCC号码	机车号	车次号	线路	Layer	消息类型	子类型
4	2022-11-13 17:33:46.577	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	Physical	Signaling	CONNECT_ACK
5	2022-11-13 17:33:48.280	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	DL	RLC frame	RRM
6	2022-11-13 17:33:48.874	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	DL	RLC frame	RRM
7	2022-11-13 17:33:49.108	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	DL	RLC frame	I
8	2022-11-13 17:33:49.108	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	Net	NPDU	Data
9	2022-11-13 17:33:49.139	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	DL	RLC frame	I
10	2022-11-13 17:33:49.874	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	Net	NPDU	I
11	2022-11-13 17:33:49.139	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	Transport	TFDU	CR
12	2022-11-13 17:33:49.139	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	Safety	SAFPU	ATI
13	2022-11-13 17:33:49.233	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	DL	RLC frame	RR
14	2022-11-13 17:33:49.249	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	DL	RLC frame	RR
15	2022-11-13 17:33:49.827	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	DL	RLC frame	I
16	2022-11-13 17:33:49.827	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	Net	NPDU	Data
17	2022-11-13 17:33:49.874	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	DL	RLC frame	I
18	2022-11-13 17:33:49.874	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	Net	NPDU	Data
19	2022-11-13 17:33:49.874	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	Transport	TFDU	CC
20	2022-11-13 17:33:49.874	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	Safety	SAFPU	ADR
21	2022-11-13 17:33:50.452	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	DL	RLC frame	RR
22	2022-11-13 17:33:50.467	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	DL	RLC frame	RR
23	2022-11-13 17:33:50.717	44904184065	2410502	15461	67615	宁杭	DL	RLC frame	RR

Fig. 5: PRI interface call records for service G7615.

Based on the analysis of the three-interface data mentioned above, it can be observed that if the vehicle equipment operates with a single radio (MT), i.e., one MT radio malfunctioning, there are clear characteristics in the data records. At this point, it can serve as a signal to prompt vehicle equipment maintenance personnel to repair or replace the faulty radio.

B. Wireless Communication Interference

The characteristics of network interference are characterized by suddenness and repetitive failures. When the high-speed train passes through an interference zone during operation, it experiences sudden wireless connection timeouts. However, once the train exits the interference zone, the wireless communication automatically returns to normal. Subsequently, other trains passing through the same location also encounter similar faults.

During the analysis of wireless connection timeouts, it was observed that certain fixed locations frequently experienced such issues. After conducting on-site inspections and tests, it was discovered that there were telecommunication operator base stations nearby or interfering signals present. Once the interference was eliminated, the fault rate significantly decreased. In such operational scenarios, the key focus of analysis and investigation should be on GSM-R network interference. Below is a specific case analysis.

On December 1, 2022, during the operation of the CR380D-1584 high-speed train on the G2333 service, a wireless connection timeout fault alarm occurred at the location of 254KM+805M on the Hangzhou-Changsha Passenger Dedicated Line. Based on the Abis interface data from the three interfaces, the GSM-R network measurement report is shown in Fig. 6. At 9:38:26.490, the uplink communication quality value changed to 7 (measuring the level of signal quality, ranging from 0 to 7, where 0 indicates the best quality and 7 indicates the worst quality). Simultaneously, the downlink signal level and communication quality measurement values were missing.

[illegible]

Fig. 6: Abis interface data for service

Based on this inference, when the wireless connection timeout fault alarm occurs, there may be interference in the communication at that location. If the wireless connection timeout fault continues to occur at that location, it is advisable to notify communication equipment maintenance personnel to conduct network quality measurements on-site. By identifying the specific faulty components, locate the faulty component and replace it.

C. RBC Device Failure

Once the RBC (Radio Block Center) equipment malfunctions, all trains running within its jurisdiction will experience wireless connection timeout fault alarms. The specific reasons for such alarms may be due to interruptions in communication between

the RBC and the GSM-R network or self-restart of the RBC system. A specific case analysis is provided below.

On April 5, 2023, at 6:53:48, both the G7554 and G2668 train services experienced wireless connection timeout fault alarms while operating on the Hangzhou-Changsha high-speed line. The PRI interface data from the three interfaces is shown in Fig. 7 and 8. It can be observed that the data exchange between the ATP (Automatic Train Protection) equipment and RBC devices for these two trains encountered delays of over 20 seconds without a response. This situation may indicate a malfunction in the RBC equipment. In such cases, it is advisable to prompt RBC equipment maintenance personnel to inspect the operational status of the equipment and consider replacing any faulty components.

[illegible]

Fig. 7: PRI interface data for service G7554.

[illegible]

Fig. 8: PRI interface data for service G2668.

IV. FAULT DIAGNOSIS METHOD BASED ON THREE-INTERFACE DATA

This paper proposes a method for diagnosing wireless connection timeout faults in high-speed train control systems based on the analysis of three-interface data using a random forest algorithm model[5]. The specific steps of the method include the following steps.

A. Data Preprocessing for Three-Interface Data

In the random forest algorithm, the input values must be integers or floating-point numbers. Therefore, the first step is to merge the data from the A, Abis, and PRI ports into a single dataset. Next, the input data undergoes preprocessing, where strings are converted into integers or floating-point numbers. The process involves filling in missing data, removing noise and irrelevant information, and extracting key terms and phrases.

B. Data Partitioning

The preprocessed data is divided into training data and testing data. The training set will be used for training the subsequent decision trees, while the testing set will be used to validate the performance of the decision trees. In total, there are 4770 data points, and after merging the A, Abis, and PRI port data, there are 1590 data points. Out of these, 1200 data points are selected as the training dataset, and the remaining 390 data points are used as the testing dataset. List the fields that affect the fault

diagnosis result, including trigger time, MSISDN/IMSI, train number, cell, uplink and downlink communication quality, message type, subtype, Direction, Explan, and the corresponding parameter values and precision.

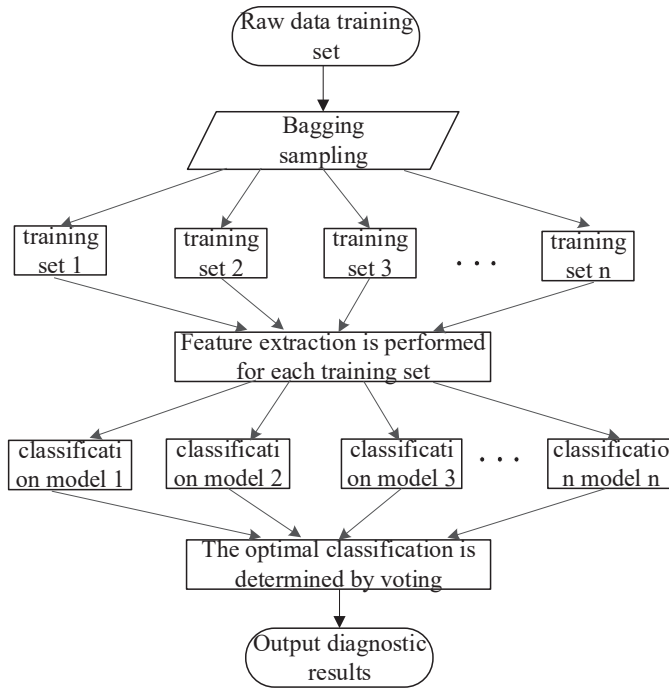


Fig. 9: Flow chart of random forest algorithm.

C. Fault Classification Model Training

The Bagging method is used for training the model. In this approach, samples are randomly selected with replacement from the training set, and decision trees are trained using randomly selected subsets of features. This setting increases the independence of decision tree construction, enhancing the model's resilience to noise and improving its generalization ability. The Bagging method is repeatedly applied to the training set until all the required decision trees are constructed. The final output of the random forest algorithm is determined by

aggregating the results from all the decision trees, the specific process is shown in Fig. 9.

V. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

The paper proposes an intelligent fault diagnosis method for wireless communication timeout in high-speed train control systems based on three-interface data. This method utilizes the random forest classification model to accomplish fault diagnosis.

In the next step, the authors plan to leverage Prognostics and Health Management (PHM) technology for predictive analysis of wireless communication timeout faults. This approach aims to achieve dynamic health management of the control system equipment, further reducing the probability of wireless communication timeout faults occurring between trains and the ground control center.

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